

# Black+Decker A1 Series TV

Affordable LED LCD TV with accurate colours

₹36,990

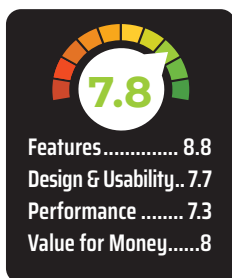


**T**he budget TV segment is booming right now. New brands like Black and Decker and JVC are stepping in, shaking things up. Today, we'll discuss the Black & Decker 55-inch A1 Series TV - an affordable 55-inch TV that is licensed and distributed by Indkal Technologies in India. We'll talk about all the details in this review and I'll also reveal a hidden setting in the menu that can dramatically improve this TV's picture quality.

## DISPLAY QUALITY

This Black and Decker TV comes with a VA LCD panel. Initially, I assumed it was a QLED TV but when I ran the colour gamut tests I realised it was not.

The panel can reproduce almost 97% of the Rec 709 colour space used for SDR content.



DCI-P3 and BT2020 coverage stands at 83% and 62%, which are relevant to HDR content. Colour Volume, which measures colours at different luminance levels, is also in line with what we expect from regular LED LCD TVs.

We recorded a native contrast of 5000:1 from the VA panel, which is great in this segment.

Viewing angles are not very wide as is often the case with VA displays on affordable TVs. We noticed a shift in colours off-axis which is the trade-off you make for higher contrast. We noticed a peak brightness of 515 nits which certainly exceeded our expectations.

## PICTURE QUALITY

The Movie preset has a white point close to standard D65, and it is also the most colour-accurate mode on this TV.

The display is tuned for viewing in a normal or bright viewing environment and follows a tone curve close to gamma 2.2 for SDR. Initially, there seemed to be a lot wrong with picture quality, like too much red in skin tones and several colour inconsistencies.

The culprit was AI. This is the sneaky setting I referred to at the start and it's buried deep in the advanced picture mode settings. AI is prominent in marketing material and is enabled by default. Perhaps, Black and Decker considers this a better presentation for people who prefer boosted colours. However, if you prefer colour accuracy it is better to disable it.

After disabling AI, the average delta error in SDR dropped from 4 to just 1.5 which is excellent. Colours and skin tones in SDR content look natural, but I can't help but notice that blacks aren't as deep - which is again totally acceptable at this price point.

The TV supports HDR10, HLG and Dolby Vision HDR formats. Overall the HDR performance is decent but falls a little short of what you'd get with some QLED options in the same budget.

Dolby Vision support counts as an advantage, despite the modest panel capabilities. That is because quite a lot of HDR content on streaming apps is in Dolby Vision these days and the A1 at least performs better for such content as compared to affordable TVs that don't support Dolby Vision.

MEMC or motion smoothing is enabled by default in Dolby Vision. I prefer to disable it to avoid unnatural motion or soap opera effects. The TV tends to slightly over-brighten HDR, so Dolby Vision Dark seems to be the best profile, more so when viewing dark ambience.

Colour accuracy for HDR10 is slightly off and we recorded an average delta error of 4.1 which is still fairly above average in the affordable segment. This is mostly because the TV tracks brighter than the reference in HDR as is evident from the PQ EOTF curve. This is also evident in bright HDR sequences where specular highlights appear burnt on the TV. If we factor out the luminance error,